Slovak Republic: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- The Slovak Republic is most exposed in upstream gas, upstream coal and downstream oil, with Energy Security higher than only 6%, 7% and 11% of the other economies scored. Trade deficits pull the upstream sectors down; low, falling consumption per person pulls oil down.[1]
- Its strongest openings are in midstream electric vehicles, midstream gas and downstream nuclear, with Economic Opportunity higher than 94%, 85% and 85% of the other economies scored; investment or trade lifts each.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, its top Strategic Index sectors are downstream batteries, upstream wind and midstream nuclear, almost tied. In upstream wind, midstream nuclear and midstream batteries, top priority meets the most policy.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates the Czech Republic highest, then Germany, both also its leading trade partners. Russia and China are each a strong tie today that the index ranks lower.[1]

1. Energy security risks and why

14 of the Slovak Republic's 30 placed sectors, those whose scores can be compared with other economies, sit in the two low-energy-security corners. Energy Security measures how well a country can rely on what it needs in a sector. Compared with other economies, its Energy Security is lowest in upstream gas, upstream coal, downstream oil and midstream nuclear. Its scores there are higher than only 6%, 7%, 11% and 12% of the other 97, 95, 98 and 153 economies scored. Of these, upstream gas, upstream coal and downstream oil sit in the Secure corner, and midstream nuclear in the Upgrade corner.[1]

The data's high-priority sectors, its Upgrade sectors with the best Strategic Index ranks, are upstream wind, midstream nuclear and midstream batteries. In midstream nuclear the score is 0.40, and trade pulls it down. Its trade deficit in these goods was 0.1% of GDP in 2023; on this measure it scores higher than only 1% of the other economies. For context, Russia supplied 94.6% of its USD 132 m of imports of these goods in 2024. In midstream batteries, trade pulls the score down too: the deficit was 1.1% of GDP in 2023.[1,2,3]

In upstream gas, the reserves and trade categories pull the score down: no gas reserves are recorded, which the index counts as zero, and the trade deficit was 1.5% of GDP in 2023. For context, Russia supplied 98.0% of its imports of these goods in 2024. In downstream oil, energy access pulls the score down: consumption was 30.6 GJ per person in 2025 and changed by -1.3% over the years to 2025.[2,3,4]

2. Economic opportunities and why

22 of the 30 placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners. Economic Opportunity measures how well placed a country is to create value in a sector. Compared with other economies, it is highest in

midstream electric vehicles, midstream gas, downstream nuclear and midstream nuclear, higher than 94%, 85%, 85% and 81% of the other economies scored. The sectors other than midstream nuclear sit in the Grow corner, which the paper's framework associates with export promotion.[1]

In midstream electric vehicles, investment pushes the score up: on annual investment it scores higher than 91% of the other economies. For context, its exports of these goods were USD 17.1 bn in 2024, and its largest market was Germany (20.9%).[1,3]

In midstream gas, trade pushes the score up: its reported exports were USD 1.05 bn in 2024. Its revealed comparative advantage, the weight of these goods in its exports relative to world exports, was 1.27. In midstream nuclear, trade also pushes the score up: on export feasibility, which measures related capabilities, it scores higher than 78% of the other economies. In downstream nuclear, energy access pushes the score up: consumption in this sector was 38.4 GJ per person in 2025.[1,4,5]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by opportunity, security need, policy activity, stage and low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it ranks downstream batteries 1st, upstream wind 2nd, midstream nuclear 3rd, midstream batteries 4th and upstream solar 5th among the Slovak Republic's own sectors. The scores are almost tied: downstream batteries leads with 0.65, and the gaps between neighbours are 0.007, 0.002, 0.005 and 0.002. Its lead rests on policy activity: without the policy term, it ranks only 15th. In upstream wind, midstream nuclear and midstream batteries, all in the Upgrade corner, security need adds the most to the score: 0.179 in midstream nuclear, against 0.166 for opportunity. The paper's framework associates that corner with building domestic capability.[1]

The allied pick, the leading upstream or midstream sector after a screen for resource endowment, is midstream nuclear (0.64), almost tied with midstream batteries (0.005 apart). The screen leaves out upstream wind, for which no resource base is recorded.[6]

Policy activity counts International Energy Agency Policies and Measures records and reads the Climate Action Tracker rating against each technology. The Slovak Republic carries the rating Insufficient (November 2024) and has 156 such records, 76 of which name a technology. Comparing priority, the index without its policy term, with policy activity, top priority meets the most policy in upstream wind, midstream nuclear and midstream batteries. No top-priority sector falls among those with the least policy. Priority and policy agree at the bottom in 7 sectors, every coal and oil sector among them.[1,7,8]

4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index rates partners as reliable suppliers (Friendshore), as export markets (Partnership Opportunity) and, for middle- and lower-income partners, by Development Potential. From the Slovak Republic's viewpoint it ranks the Czech Republic 1st, Germany 2nd, Italy 3rd, the United Kingdom 4th and Austria 5th of 191 partners. The Czech Republic and Austria each stand out as a reliable supplier. Germany, Italy and the United Kingdom each stand out as an export market; for Germany the best sectors are midstream wind, midstream electric grid, downstream nuclear, midstream solar and midstream batteries.[1]

Today's trade matches part of this list. Germany is the Slovak Republic's 1st trade partner on average across its energy-goods baskets, the Czech Republic its 2nd and Austria its 7th; each is a priority partner with strong ties today. Italy and the United Kingdom trade less, ranking 12th and 19th. All of these partners vote

in the same bloc as the Slovak Republic at the UN, and all but Austria share membership of NATO with it. By contrast, Russia is its 5th trade partner but ranks 70th on Partnership Strength, and China is its 6th but ranks 30th. In UN votes, the Slovak Republic and each of them sit in opposite blocs.[1,3,9,10]

As a partner to the coalition, the Slovak Republic ranks 21st of 192 economies on Partnership Strength averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design, which spreads upstream and midstream production across coalition members, its largest designed shares are 0.3% of midstream gas and 0.3% of midstream wind.[1,6]

5. Data notes and caveats

Country Insights shows more (12 October 2026).

- Scores compare the Slovak Republic with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms.
- All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings.
- Some figures behind these scores are filled in where the source has no value: with zero where a source lists every holder, otherwise with the world average.
- Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order.
- Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up.
- In the allied network design the European Union is one producer; the Slovak Republic's shares are derived from its weight within the EU.
- The Climate Action Tracker rates the EU as a whole; the Slovak Republic carries the EU's rating.
- The Slovak Republic's counts leave out the EU's own 438 International Energy Agency policy records.
- Trade figures count trade with other EU members.

Sources

1. Energy Security, Economic Opportunity, Strategic Index and Partnership Strength Index, paper baseline (Opportunity Security Indices pipeline); CC BY 4.0 (the paper's indices).
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10. Economic-security agreements: G7, NATO, Indo-Pacific Economic Framework, Minerals Security Partnership (and Forum), U.S. free-trade agreements (compiled by the authors from official membership lists).